

THE STUDY • PRELIMINARY • ANALYSIS IN PROGRESS • NOT YET PEER-REVIEWED

Can meditation support women living with breast cancer? A randomized trial of a six-week online SOS meditation program



University of Central Florida



Johns Hopkins University • Oncology



Virginia Commonwealth University



hope

&



stress

ROSE MORE WITH MEDITATION

FELL WITHIN THE MEDITATION GROUP

Among 78 women living with or beyond breast cancer, a 6-week SOS meditation program lifted *hope* and eased *stress*.



WHO
78 women, breast cancer journey

Women currently in treatment for breast cancer or in survivorship after treatment. Participants were randomized to two groups.



WHAT
6 weeks of SOS meditation

One arm received the 6-wk SOS meditation program online; the other was a waitlist control. Outcomes were assessed across multiple timepoints.



WE FOUND
Hope rose, stress eased

Statistical models showed a significantly greater rise in hope for the meditation arm. Within the meditation arm, stress also fell significantly.



WHAT DIDN'T MOVE
Some outcomes did not differ

Depression eased over time for both arms equally. Heart-rate variability did not show systematic group differences in this preliminary analysis.

OUTCOMES MEASURED

All five outcomes – an honest snapshot

Hope



CLEAR EFFECT meditation more than waitlist over time (significant Group × Time)

Stress



WITHIN-GROUP ONLY fell significantly within the meditation arm only

Anxiety



MIXED RESULT significant Group × Time interaction, but no reliable difference at endpoint

Depression



NO GROUP DIFFERENCE eased in both arms – no differential effect

Heart-rate variability



NO GROUP DIFFERENCE no systematic change or group differences

STATUS & CAUTIONS Preliminary findings.

! WHERE THIS STANDS: Data analysis is in progress; the manuscript is being finalized. Expected submission June 2026. **No peer review yet.**

➔ WHAT THIS IS, AND ISN'T: A small RCT (n = 78) in women living with breast cancer. Findings **suggest** meditation may help with hope and stress during this period; they are not a treatment recommendation.

➔ Always consult your care team about supportive practices alongside medical treatment.

HOW TO READ THIS

Preliminary results. RCT, n = 78, all women with current or past breast cancer treatment. Statistical analyses are being finalized; reported findings may shift in the published paper. Multi-site, multi-institution collaboration.

RESEARCHERS • UNPUBLISHED

Young ME, Dorais S, Gutierrez D, Sheng J, Sukumar S, Ritz L, Saggar A. A randomized controlled trial of a low-dose meditation intervention on psychological outcomes for individuals living with breast cancer. *Manuscript in preparation, 2026*. Institutions involved include the University of Central Florida, College of William & Mary, Virginia Commonwealth University, Johns Hopkins University, and the University of Florida.

